

USER EXPERIENCE · 2026

The Journey Layout

A Markdown-native, list-and-inline-code driven user-journey diagram.
One layout, five variants — each answers a different question about
the experience you're documenting.

SECTION 01

Authoring · nested list + inline code.

How to write a journey

Sections are top-level list items **Tasks** are nested list items

Actors are inline-code `@name` tokens — appearance order drives the legend

Mood is `:1` (pain) → `:5` (delight); default `:3` if omitted

Volume is `+N` for the weighted variant — task width scales by this number

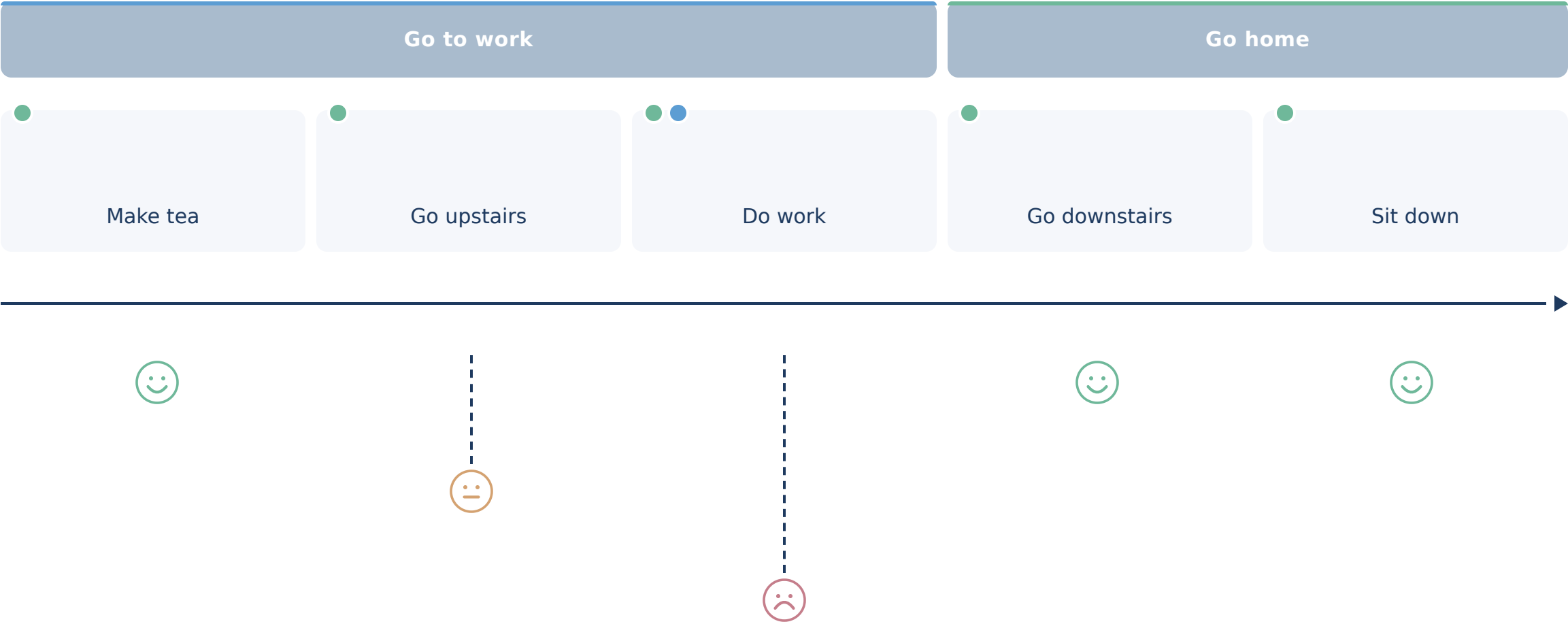
The same five lines of Markdown render in any of the five variants —
swap `journey` for `journey heatmap`, `journey curve`, etc.

SECTION 02

Classic · the default Mermaid look.

My working day

● me ● cat

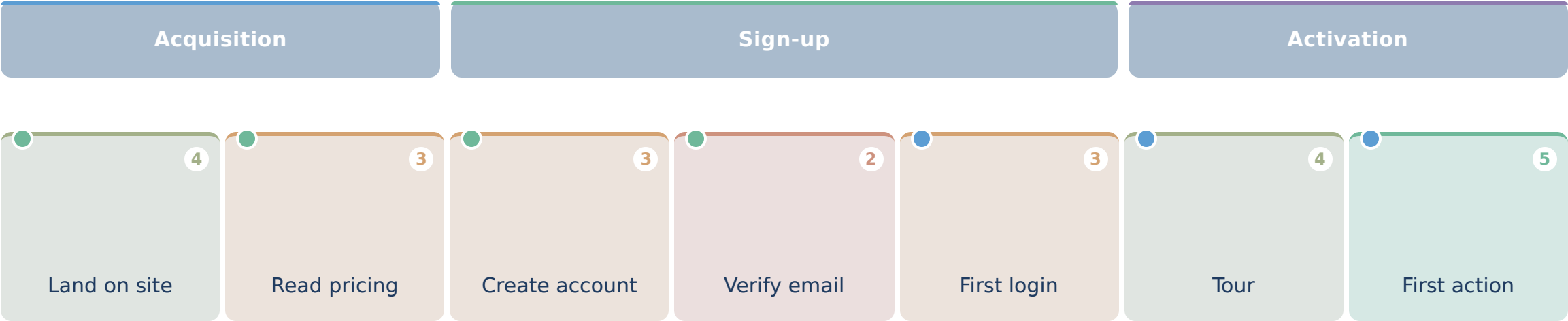


SECTION 03

Heatmap · friction at a glance.

Onboarding · where do we lose people?

● visitor ● user



SECTION 04

Curve · the emotional arc.

Quarterly close · the shape of the week

● finance ● cfo

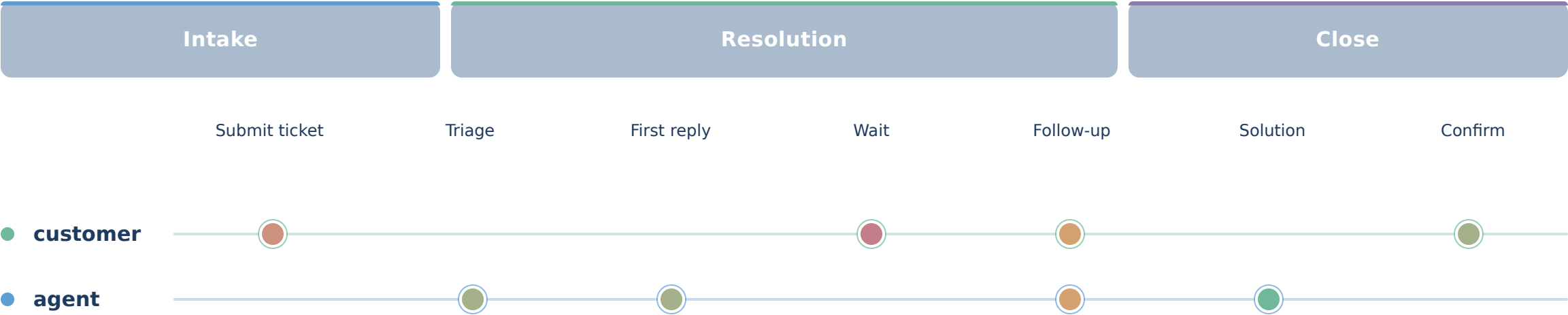


SECTION 05

Swimlane · who feels what, where.

Support escalation · two perspectives

● customer ● agent

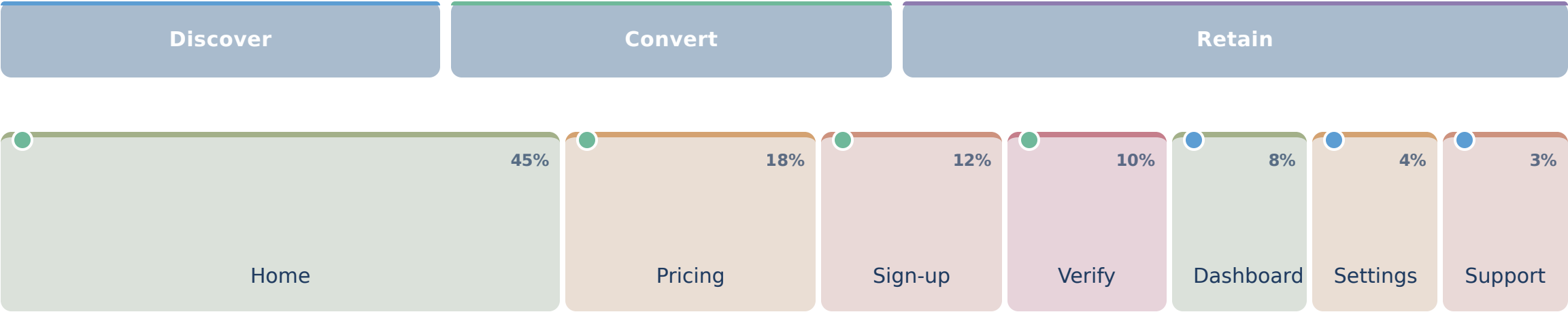


SECTION 06

Weighted · volume × pain in one view.

Where to invest · prioritized by traffic

● visitor ● user



SECTION 07

Picking a variant.

Which variant when?

journey — boardroom-familiar Mermaid look; lowest learning cost

journey heatmap — fastest exec scan; "where are the red spots?"

journey curve — narrative; "what's the shape of the experience?"

journey swimlane — cross-functional; "who feels what, where?"

journey weighted — decision-grade; "invest where pain × volume is highest"

Default is **journey** (classic). All five variants accept the same authored Markdown — only the class changes.

USER JOURNEYS, THEMED AND TOKENIZED

One layout · five views.

Same Markdown, same data, five distinct analytical reads. Picks up the active theme's palette through `--cat-*` tokens; mood ramp is `--journey-mood-1` ... `--journey-mood-5`.